

RAJIV GANDHI UNIVERSITY OF KNOWLEDGE TECHNOLOGIES

(A State University Established by Act 18 of 2008, Govt. of Andhra Pradesh)

Campuses: Nuzvid | RK Valley (Idupulapaya) | Srikakulam | Ongole

BIOGRAPHICAL PROFILE & ACADEMIC DOSSIER

Prof. Maddali Lakshmi Narayana Rao (M. L. N. Rao) — Vice-Chancellor, RGUKT-AP

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY & CURRENT APPOINTMENT

Prof. Maddali Lakshmi Narayana Rao (M.L.N. Rao) is a distinguished chemist, educator, and Higher Administrative Grade (HAG) Professor from the Department of Chemistry at the Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur (IIT Kanpur), currently serving as the Vice-Chancellor of Rajiv Gandhi University of Knowledge Technologies, Andhra Pradesh (RGUKT-AP).

As Vice-Chancellor and Member-Convener of the University Governing Council, Prof. Rao leads institutional governance, academic synchronization, research culture, and campus development across the four regional IIIT campuses (Nuzvid, RK Valley, Srikakulam, and Ongole).

2. ACADEMIC QUALIFICATIONS & POSTDOCTORAL RESEARCH

- **Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D.) in Chemistry (1996):** University of Hyderabad (School of Chemistry) under the mentorship of Prof. M. Periasamy.
- **Postdoctoral Research Fellow (1994–1997):** Department of Chemistry, Wayne State University, Michigan, USA.
- **Postdoctoral Research Associate (1997–1999):** School of Chemical Sciences, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign (UIUC), USA.

3. DISTINGUISHED CAREER AT IIT KANPUR (2003–PRESENT)

Prof. Rao joined IIT Kanpur as Assistant Professor in 2003, subsequently advancing to Associate Professor (2009), Professor (2013), and Higher Administrative Grade (HAG) Professor. Over two decades at IIT Kanpur, he has taught advanced undergraduate and postgraduate organic chemistry, mentored over 15 Ph.D. scholars, and led major sponsored research projects funded by DST, CSIR, and BRNS.

4. RESEARCH EXPERTISE & SCHOLARLY CONTRIBUTIONS

- **Pioneered 'Rao Cross-Coupling':** Internationally recognized for developing atom-economic, sustainable cross-coupling reactions utilizing triarylbi-muth reagents in palladium catalysis.
- **Publication Record:** Authored over 110+ peer-reviewed scientific papers in top-tier journals including *Organic Letters*, *The Journal of Organic Chemistry (ACS)*, *Chemical Communications (RSC)*, and *European Journal of Organic Chemistry*.
- **Awards & Recognition:** Recipient of the CRSI Bronze Medal (Chemical Research Society of India), Distinguished Alumni Award (University of Hyderabad), and visiting professorships at premier global universities.

5. VISION FOR RGUKT-AP

Prof. Rao's administrative roadmap for RGUKT-AP emphasizes outcome-based learning, establishment of interdisciplinary Quantum Computing and AI laboratories, strengthening teacher-student research interfaces, standardizing examination evaluation, and expanding industry internships to empower rural engineering students for global competitiveness.

6. OFFICIAL CONTACT & OFFICE ADDRESS

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